

Vehicle Maintenance Interval Guidelines

General maintenance intervals for passenger vehicles under typical driving conditions. Vehicles used for towing, frequent short trips, dusty environments, or extreme temperatures should follow the more conservative "severe service" schedule where noted. Always defer to the vehicle-specific manufacturer schedule where it differs from these general guidelines.

Routine Maintenance Schedule

Interval	Item	Action
Every 8,000-12,000 km or 6 months	Engine oil & filter	Replace; check more frequently under severe service conditions
Every 12,000-15,000 km	Engine air filter	Inspect; replace if visibly dirty or clogged
Every 15,000-30,000 km	Cabin air filter	Inspect and replace; more frequently in dusty environments
Every 30,000-50,000 km	Brake fluid	Test moisture content; flush if beyond specification (or every 2 years regardless of mileage)
Every 40,000-60,000 km	Spark plugs	Inspect gap and electrode wear; replace per plug type (iridium plugs last considerably longer)
Every 60,000-100,000 km	Coolant	Flush and replace with manufacturer-specified type
Every 60,000-100,000 km	Transmission fluid	Inspect condition and level; service per manufacturer schedule (some sealed units are "lifetime")
Every 20,000-40,000 km	Brake pads	Inspect thickness; replace when below ~3mm friction material
Every 10,000-15,000 km or annually	Tire rotation & pressure	Rotate to promote even wear; check pressure monthly regardless of mileage
Every 2 years or per manufacturer	12V battery	Load test; most lead-acid batteries last 3-5 years
Annually	Wiper blades	Replace if streaking, skipping, or cracked

Severe Service Conditions

Follow the shorter end of each interval range above if your driving matches any of the following:

- Frequent short trips (under 10 km) that never fully warm the engine
- Extensive idling or low-speed stop-and-go traffic
- Towing, hauling heavy loads, or roof-rack cargo
- Dusty, sandy, or gravel-road environments
- Extreme cold (below -20°C) or extreme heat (above 40°C) climates
- Driving on salted roads during winter

When to See a Mechanic Immediately

Certain warning signs indicate a fault that should not wait for the next scheduled service interval:

- Any red dashboard warning light (oil pressure, brake system, coolant temperature, battery/charging)
- Grinding, squealing, or metal-on-metal noise while braking
- A burning smell, visible smoke, or fluid pooling under the vehicle
- Sudden loss of power steering or braking assist
- Engine stalling while driving, or difficulty restarting
- A significant, sudden drop in fuel economy or engine performance